

Seminar Class
on
Fundamentals of Research Paper Writing:
An Introduction to Essential Skills and
Techniques

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Before You Start Writing

❖ Reading is a Reaping Process

- ❖ R= Read the texts in the context, explore the message of the text
- ❖ E= Encode in your own words
- ❖ A= Analyse with SAFEER
- ❖ P= Pondering-Associate your reading with your internal and external worlds (Knowledge of words and knowledge of the world)



Scientific Writing

- ❖ Scientific Writing in an **impersonal and dispassionate tone**, targeted for a **critical and informed audience**, based on **closely investigated knowledge**, and **intended to reinforce or challenge concepts or argument**
- ❖ Any writing to fulfill a requirement of a college or university
- ❖ Whatness ?+ Whyness? +Howness ? + Objective Reflection
- ❖ Claim + evidences + theoretical insights + reflection

Why Write it Up

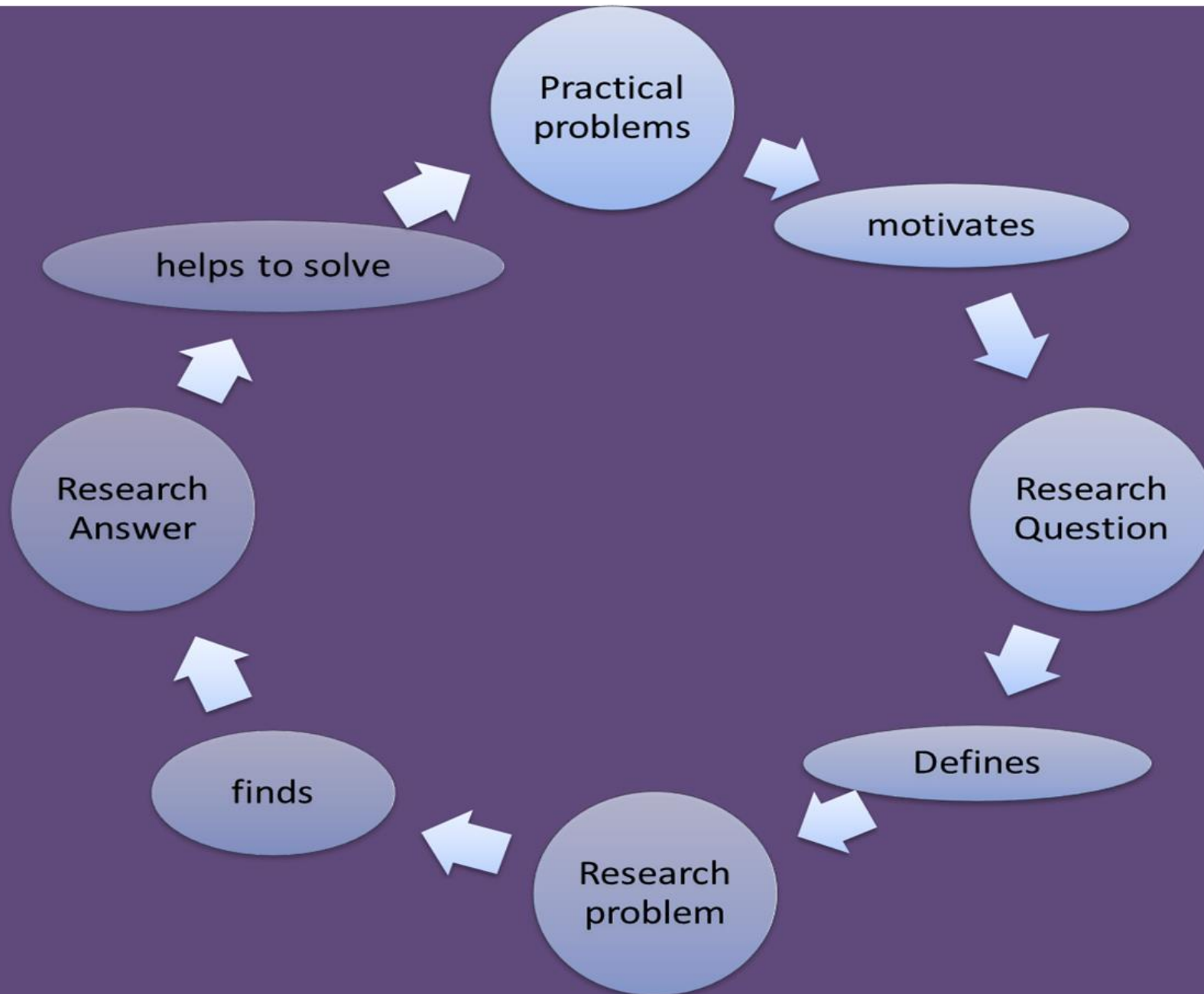
- ❖ Write to remember
- ❖ Write to understand
- ❖ Write to test your thinking
- ❖ Write to apply your knowledge and wisdom
- ❖ Write to analyse
- ❖ Write to evaluate
- ❖ Write to create



Connecting with Your Readers

- ❖ **Scientific writing is a social conversation/interaction between two personas**
 - i. Who will read my research report?
 - ii. What do they expect me to do?
 - iii. How much can I expect them to know already?
 - iv. How will readers respond to the solution/answer in my main claim?

Source: *The Craft of Research*, 3rd edition, pp.26-27



Documenting Sources

- ❖ **Annotated Bibliography**

- ❖ **Citation**

- ❖ **Bibliography**

- i. **Works Cited**

- ii. **References**

Annotation

- ❖ **Critical commentary or explanation**
- ❖ **A note, comment, or a concise statement of the key ideas in a text or a portion of a text**
- ❖ **Commonly used in reading instruction and in research**
- ❖ **A vital part of a researcher's ability to understand any given text comprehensively**
- ❖ **The process of annotation is almost essential to retaining the knowledge necessary to understand a text's key points and features**



Annotated Bibliography

- ❖ Preparing the list of such annotation in alphabetical order
- ❖ Olin and Uris libraries of Cornell University in 2008 offer practical advice on preparing an annotated bibliography

“An annotated bibliography is a list of citation to books, articles, and documents. Each citation is followed by a brief, usually about 150 words, descriptive and evaluated paragraph, the annotation. The purpose of the annotation is to inform the reader of the relevance, accuracy and quality of the sources cited. The annotation is a concise and succinct analysis.”

Kido, A., Yamamoto, N., Masui, M., & Takeuchi, Y. (2012). Study on formation of urban tissue in Bhaktapur in Kathmandu Valley, Nepal. *Journal of Science and Engineering*, 1(1), 1-16.

The research employs a dual methodology to understand urban formation: analyzing physical elements (streets, squares, plots) and studying activity patterns around shrines and water sources. Using space syntax and axial line analysis, they discovered higher integration values in the western area, while the eastern section's winding streets suggest earlier settlements. The mapping of religious elements (Ganesh shrines), water sources (hiti), and dwelling units revealed significant patterns. The distribution of Ganesh shrines beyond current boundaries indicates historical boundary shifts. Four distinct relationships between communities and water sources were identified, along with three dwelling unit types relative to pikhalakhus. Analysis based on Pant's (2001) work concludes that courtyard buildings preceded linear buildings with self-contained pikhalakhus, resulting in a double-layered urban tissue. This evolutionary pattern demonstrates how Bhaktapur's urban morphology developed through a complex interplay of religious, social, and functional needs, with early settlements expanding from east to west. This research significantly contributes to understanding historical urban development patterns in traditional Nepalese cities through structural analysis.

Sapkota, J. L. (15 Jan. 2018). Land as (In)security in Chinua Achebe's *Things Fall Apart*. *Crossing the Border: Journal of Interdisciplinary Studies*, 6(1), 14-27.

This paper analyses how land can be associated with human (in)security and it contributes in shaping person's identity in Achebe's *Things Fall Apart* through ecocritical perspective. *Things Fall Apart* is set in Umuofia, the precolonial Igbo land of South Eastern Nigeria. Thee Umofians value their attachment with their land very highly, and even worship their land as the goddess earth. The idea of exploiting land for anthropocentric interest is unimaginable for the Umuofians. Their cultural, physical and mental lives are shaped by their environment. Their agrarian lifestyle, religious beliefs, feasts and festivals, rites and rituals, myths and folk tales, and proverbs and sayings have a profound signature of the flora, fauna and landscapes of their dwelling place. This attachment binds them into an organic community as they internalize their existence in relation to their relationship to that organic. They feel their independent identity in their homeland. After the arrival of Christian missionaries into their community, however, they feel their sacred bonds with their places cut off, perceive themselves as fallen apart, and experience uncertainty, insecurity and danger for their existence in their own homeland. As a result, they feel their homeland under assault and suffer from solastalgia.

Silva, K. D. (2015). The spirit of place of Bhaktapur, Nepal. *International Journal of Heritage Studies*, 21(8), 820–841.

<https://doi.org/10.1080/13527258.2015.1028962>

The research uniquely approaches heritage by focusing on residents' emotional connections rather than just tangible and intangible heritage elements. The author establishes four qualitative dimensions: sacrality (measured through shrine memories), community (family and social bonds), serenity (lifestyle and environmental quality), and historicity (physical attributes and traditions). The findings reveal that Bhaktapur's spirit emerges from a complex interweaving of these dimensions. The strong sense of sacrality is evidenced through both physical shrines and intangible practices. Community cohesion transcends caste and religious boundaries. Serenity, despite lacking natural features, manifests through social harmony and environmental quality. Historicity is preserved through traditional architecture, crafts, and cultural practices. Critical analysis concludes that the spirit of place is fundamentally experiential and cannot be fully captured by conventional heritage documentation. However, the author identifies potential threats to sacrality and serenity, indicating the delicate balance between preservation and modern development. This research provides valuable insights for heritage management approaches that consider local residents' lived experiences alongside physical conservation.

Realize

- ❖ When you go through any text, write briefly
 - i. What is the text about?
 - ii. What is its major argument?
 - iii. How does the author support his/her argument?
 - iv. What conclusion does the author draw?
- ❖ The brief succinct answers of these questions will be the gist of the text.
- ❖ When these answers are preceded by publication information of the text, it becomes annotated bibliography.

Title

- ❖ Intelligent, and telling (avoids wording that is vague, garrulous, and pretentious)
- ❖ Use key words that relate to subject area, disciplinary practice, and foreshadow the major argument
- ❖ Title must have Issue raised+ primary text/study area
- ❖ Capitalize the first letter of the title

Title Selection

Area: Early 19th century English literature

Genre: Poetry

Sub-genre: Romantic Poetry

Subject: William Wordsworth

Topic: The Tintern Abbey

Issue: Assimilation of Self into Nature

Perspective: Ecocriticism



Area: National Security and International Relations

Genre: International Affairs of a Nation

Sub-genre: Defense and Foreign Policy

Subject: Small Nations' Defense and Foreign Policy

Topic: Defense and Foreign Policy of Nepal

Issue: Constraints of Nepal's Defense and Foreign Policy

Perspective: Structural Realism



Area: Economy and Development

Genre: Political Economy

Sub-genre: International Cooperation and Connectivity

Subject: BRI of China

Topic: Collaboration, Cooperation and Connectivity for Development

Issue: BRI and Geo-political Conflict in Nepal

Perspective: Security and Development Studies





Area: Buddhist Heritage Tourism

Genre: Buddhist Cultural Heritage in Nepal

Sub-genre: Lumbini. Kapilbastu and Peripheral Areas

Subject: Lumbini

Topic: Mayadevi Temple

Issue: Mayadevi temple, World Heritage Site and Cultural Tourism in Lumbini



Area: Financial Institutions

Genre: Cooperative

Subgenre: Saving and credit cooperative

Subject: Cooperatives of Baglung

Topic: Cooperatives run by women

Issue: Impact of cooperatives in women empowerment

Title: Impact of cooperatives in women empowerment
in Baglung district



Area: Marketing

Genre: Digital marketing

Subgenre: Services and Goods

Subject: Automobiles

Topic: Sale of Luxury Cars in Kathmandu Valley

Issue: Impact of Digital Marketing in the Sale of Luxury Cars in Kathmandu Valley





Area: Settlement Studies

Genre: Settlement study of ancient cite

Sub-Genre: Change in settlement morphology

Subject: Evolution of an ancient to modern sub-urban settlement

Topic: Spatial transformation of ancient settlement of Gokarna, Kathmandu

Issue: Layered Landscape and urban expansion in Gokarna

Perspective: Settlement Morphology



अध्ययन क्षेत्र: उत्तर आधुनिक साहित्य

बिधा: उपन्यास

उप बिधा: प्रवासी मजदुरका बारेमा लेखिएका उपन्यास

शिर्षक: अखण्ड भण्डारी, उमा सुवेदी

रचना: मलाया एक्सप्रेस, तोदा

सवाल: बेचैनी र सास्कृतिक अन्तरघुलनको समस्या

सैद्धान्तिक दृष्टिकोण: आप्रवासी श्रम अध्ययन



अध्ययन क्षेत्र: नेपाली पर्यावरण साहित्य

बिधा: कविता

उप बिधा: नेपाली पर्यावरण कविता

बिषय: लेखनाथ पौडेल

रचना: तरुण तपसी

सवाल: मानव र मानवेतर जगतको अन्तरसम्बन्ध

सैद्धान्तिक दृष्टिकोण: पर्यावरण साहित्य सिद्धान्त



Writing Paragraph

- ☐ Topic Sentence (Topic, the idea or opinion that is being said, discussed or explained)
- ☐ Body of the paragraph (Support for topic, SAFEER)
- ☐ Concluding sentence (Restatement of the topic)



Topic Sentence

- ❑ Topic itself
- ❑ Controlling idea

For example:

- ❑ Successful people have three common qualities.
- ❑ There are three waves or great advances of human history.
- ❑ University education widens social horizon.

Successful people share **three common qualities**. First, people who are successful are **organized**. They do not waste time and they work in ways that maximize their efficiency. They also work longer hours. Second, they are **focused and single minded**. They can see where they want to go and only do the things that will get them there. For example, when they are working on something, they do not get lost in the details or overwhelmed by the tasks they need to do. Finally, people who are successful must be **able to set and accomplish goals**. Not many people succeed without these qualities. Therefore, successful people are **organized, focused and goal-oriented**.



There are **three waves or great advances** of **human civilization**. The first wave depends on human and animal muscle. It is called **Agricultural Revolution**. The second wave the expression of machine muscle or **Industrial Revolution**. It introduces different wonderful innovations and discovery. The third not on human and animal or machine muscle but on mind. It is what we call age of **Computer and Information Technology**. After facing these waves or great advances of human civilization, now we are in the era where the world has become like a **small village, popularly known as global village**.



References

- Creswell, J. W., & Creswell, J. D. (2022). *Research design: Qualitative, quantitative and mixed methods approaches*. 6th edition. SAGE publication, Inc.
- Graff, G., Birkenstein, C., & Durst, R.(2022). *They say/I say the moves that matters in academic writing*. W. W. Norton and Company.
- Green, S., & Lidinsky, A.(2021). *From inquiry to academic writing: Practical guide*, 5th edition. Bedford/St. Martin's.
- Harris, D.(2020). *Literature review and research design: A guide to effective research Practice*. Routledge.



Home Assignment

- I. **Select title of your research article following the steps from area to perspective for your study.**
- II. **Write two paragraphs on your title.**

Research Paper

- ❖ A Research Paper is a piece of academic writing based on its author's original research on a particular topic, and the analysis and interpretation of the research findings. It can be a term paper, master's thesis or a doctoral dissertation.
- ❖ Title
- ❖ Abstract
- ❖ Key Words
- ❖ Introduction
- ❖ Study Area
- ❖ Literature Review
- ❖ Methodology/ Methods and Materials
- ❖ Result and Discussion (Body of the Paper)/Textual Analysis
- ❖ Conclusion
- ❖ Appendix
- ❖ References/Works Cited



Abstract

- ❖ **An abstract is a brief summary of a research article, thesis, review, conference proceeding, or any in-depth analysis of a particular subject or discipline**
- ❖ **It is often used to help reader quickly ascertain the paper's purpose**
- ❖ **Issue raised/explored and primary text, major argument**
- ❖ **Objectives of the study**
- ❖ **Gist of the study**
- ❖ **Significance of the study within the context of existing scholarship**
- ❖ **Abstract should be followed by Key Terms: 4-8 words**

Example

This article is an exploration of Kali, a Hindu deity, through Panofskian three-tiered meanings of visual arts: pre-iconography description, iconographical analysis and iconological interpretation. It presents neither a dogmatic nor an erotic interpretation of Kali but a purely objective analysis of the Hindu deity. It is argued that Kali has layers of implications, associations and meanings as well as multiple forms, namely Kali, Chhinnamasta Kali, Tara, Bhuvanshwori, Bagalamukhi, Dhumvawati, Kamala, Bhairavi, Sodashi, and Matangi. Each form is also associated with different mythologies, allegories, and allusions of their origin. It is assumed that this article has had great significance in the academia as well as for the academicians and academics who are interested in carrying out research works with an objective description, analysis and interpretation of any visual arts.

Introduction

A. Introductory paragraph

- ❖ **Promise sentence**
- ❖ **Text in the context: Location, situation and status of the study area**
- ❖ **Basic theoretical insights**
- ❖ **Thesis statement**
- ❖ **Introduction of key terms with authentic sources**
- ❖ **Brief Review of Relevant Literature**
- ❖ **Research Gap**

Begin like this:

This paper explores/examines/ analyzes in by applying perspective. OR This study examines ... in... by applying . . . perspective with special focus on

Literature Review

- ❖ **Follow 8Cs:** Consult, Collect, Categorize, Compare, Contrast, Cite, Critique, Connect
- ❖ **Introductory Paragraph**
 - i. What do you do in this section?
 - ii. Why do you need a thorough, sophisticated literature review?
 - iii. How have you written your literature review in this paper?
- ❖ Write reviews in chronological or thematic order
- ❖ While writing reviews, do not write only what others say but also write how your study differs from them
- ❖ Identify research gap and show your point of departure
- ❖ **End like this:**

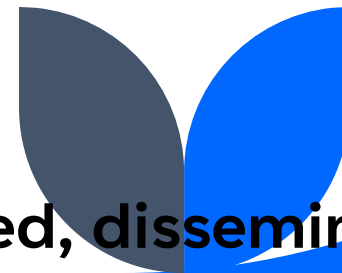
Despite these studies, there is still a lack of scholarshipTherefore, this paper aims to address/fill the gap of

Research Methodology/Methods and Materials

- ❖ Research design
- ❖ Reasons for selecting the study area
- ❖ Methods of collecting data
- ❖ Tools/processes of analysing data

Research Design

- ❖ In order to measure social phenomenon, a scientific research design is required
- ❖ Research design is simply a planning of research with the main focus on,
- ❖ **What to research (subject matter)** – Objectives, conceptual framework, hypotheses/Major Argument
- ❖ **Why to research (research problem)** – Formulation of Research problem (conceptualization)
- ❖ **How to research** (methodology) – Epistemology, theory, methods
- ❖ **Whom to research (study population)** – Population definition and sampling
- ❖ Research design also includes planning on:
- ❖ When to research, who will research, cost involved, dissemination of



Method under Qualitative Research Design

- ❖ Phenomenology
- ❖ Hermeneutics
- ❖ Content Analysis
- ❖ Thematic Categorization
- ❖ Triangulation
- ❖ Interpretive Validity

Triangulation

- ❖ **The use of multiple methods or data sources in qualitative research to develop comprehensive understanding of phenomena;**
- ❖ **A strategy in qualitative research to test validity through convergence of information/data from different sources**



Interpretative Validity

- ❖ Claim/proposition as topic sentence
- ❖ Evidence from study area
- ❖ Objective reflection over the evidence with the support of theoretical parameters

Methods of Collecting Data

A: Primary Data:

- ❖ Study Area, Questionnaire, Interview, In-depth Interview (IDI), Focused Group Discussion (FGD), Key Informants' Information (KII), etc.
- ❖ Sampling: Population, Sampling population. Sampling Methods: Purposive/Random/ Snowball Sampling

B. Secondary Data:

- ❖ Research based books, articles from Scholarly journals, Previous studies, dissertations, databases(organized collection of structured information, or data typically stored in a computer system in SQL= Structured Query Language)

Theoretical Framework

THEORY:

- ❖ A theory is a set of interrelated constructs (concepts), definitions, and propositions that presents a systematic view of phenomenon by specifying relations among variables, with the purpose of explaining and predicting the phenomenon.
- ❖ According to Bernard Cohen, "A theory is a set of interrelated universal statements, some of which are definitions and some of which are relationships assumed to be true, together with a syntax, a set of rules for manipulating the statements to arrive at new statements" (1989, p. 178).

Developing Theoretical Framework

- ❖ What is your theoretical perspective?
- ❖ What does it claim?
- ❖ What are its major trends/models?
- ❖ Which trend/model are you applying in your study?
- ❖ What does it claim?
- ❖ Who are the major theorists of this trend/model?
- ❖ Who are the major theorists you are applying?
- ❖ What are their critical insights, with reference to their authentic books and articles, that you are applying as theoretical parameters to analyse the texts under scrutiny in your study?
- ❖ **Remember:** These critical insights are Theoretical parameters in your study. These theoretical parameters constitute theoretical Framework.

Textual Analysis/Results and Discussion

- ❖ Heart of Research paper
- ❖ Provide appropriate thematic subheadings
- ❖ Provide appropriate tables, charts, graphic presentation, map
- ❖ Each paragraph must be organic: Topic sentence(idea/claim) and supportive details (SAFER)



- ❖ **Each paragraph of the body part must have:
point/claim/argument + textual/study area
evidence(s) + interpretation/Reflection supported
by theoretical insight(s)**
- ❖ **Use appropriate linking words/signal phrases to
establish cohesion between paragraphs**
- ❖ **Be careful to maintain logical development of
thoughts between paragraphs**



Analysis of *The Drought*

Claim: Planetary crisis, a result of anthropocentrism, is maintained incorporating eco-centrism. (shift)

Textual evidences:

The world looks dead, ". . . the dead birds floating in the water" (Ballard ch. 1)

"Streams that disappeared" (Ballard ch. 19).

(Ransom- science and technology)

- **Merchant** : organic world to mechanical world (p. 1,69)
- Situation is beyond human control
- Who is responsible ?
- Nature's turn- it rains at last
- **Merchant**- "Earth, a kindly benevolent female who provided for the needs of mankind" (p. 2).

Analysis of *Surfacing*

Claim- Women and nature are considered like resources to meet the goals of dominant groups.

Textual lines

“He said it wasn't a person, only an animal” (185).

Anna's body “need a naked lady” for promotion (171).

“the heron dangled, upside down (151)”/“Birches are dying (1)”

Fetus, women's body, animal, and dying trees =resources

Shiva and Miles , “we saw a connection between the oppression of Women, Children & Nature”



**She narrates, "I am a tree . . .
I am a place" (236).**

**The rules are over. I can go
anywhere now. (245).**

**This above all, to refuse to be
a victim...I re-enter my own
time" (249).**

**She is pregnant with Joe
again.**

Discussion

How does shift take place?

Two reasons:

- **From commercial artist to nature lover.**
- **She can resist masculine principles , but not men. (Ef politics inclusive, diversified)**

Karren Warren: Ecofeminist politics should not be male biased but based on pluralism.

Conclusion

- ❖ Restatement of the thesis statement
- ❖ How the gap is addressed/filled with
- ❖ Gist of the results and discussion
- ❖ Your judgmental remarks after carrying out a thorough academic research
- ❖ Recommendation for further lines of research

Language of Scientific Writing

- ❖ The prime objective of Scientific writing is to provide clear and factual communication.
- ❖ Communicative competence of the researcher ensures the effectiveness of the research report. This effectiveness of the research report can be achieved by presenting ideas in an orderly manner by expressing herself/himself smoothly and precisely.
- ❖ Thus, the qualities of a research is largely determined by maintaining **neutral tone, precision and clarity, economy in expression, use of non-discriminatory language, and continuity in presentation of ideas, smoothness of expression.**

Sources

- Creswell, J. W., & Creswell, J. D. (2022). *Research design: Qualitative, quantitative and mixed methods approaches*. 6th edition. SAGE publication, Inc.
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Thank You

